

school in Georgia. Johnny may wind up bored and unhappy. And by putting him on a slower track you may ruin his chances of getting into the most competitive colleges.

If your child is very bright and academically minded, you may need to give his schooling extra attention. You may decide, for example, to postpone your retirement for a year or two until Johnny finishes high school. That way you can set him up in a U.S. college while you're still flush. If you retire and move to the South, you may have to play more of a role in Johnny's education. Many U.S. colleges offer correspondence courses. For those subjects not available in the local high school, you can arrange for Johnny to take courses by mail. You can also supervise Johnny's reading, making sure he reads English classics, for example. You can arrange for a tutor in a foreign language, calculus, or physics.

Even after doing your best, MIT may reject Johnny's application. But that's when Johnny gets a second chance. He can apply to MIT as a sophomore. All schools know that a certain number of freshmen drop out during the first year. Schools look to transfer students to round out the sophomore class. Provided Johnny attends a good college and does well as a freshman, he should have a good shot at transferring to MIT for his sophomore year.

I'm an example of a transfer student. As a freshman I went to a small college in Michigan. Before my second year I applied at Occidental College. Occidental has very high standards, and my SAT scores were such that I doubt I'd have been accepted as a freshman. But, as my friend says, it's not where you start but where you end up that counts. Occidental accepted my transfer application and gave me full credit for my freshman year at the other school. I wound up in one of the best colleges in the country without the competitive struggle that bright high-school seniors can lose sleep over.

Once your child is in MIT, someone has to pay the bills. Assuming he transfers as a sophomore, you'll pay for only three years instead of four. That helps. But MIT can cost